love incarnate

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Explicit

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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by gaizotak

Summary

catra is a lesbian and she is love with adora. that much she knows is certain. but the world is making her feel as if her masculine identity means she has to be a man to be valid and it sends her down a new road of self discovery and gender identity that leaves her confused of who she really is and what it means to be a butch woman.

adora and the gang are here to help her figure things out as she pours herself into her art and tries to make something of herself in galleries and in her private life.

Notes

i minored in sociology and i wanted to make this fic about the struggles of being a butch lesbian in a world that tries to label us as men when that is so far from the truth. any hateful comments will be deleted :)

(if you read stone butch blues then youre cool)

read with an open mind

See the end of the work for more notes

Chapter 1

Catra jolts awake, not in a fluster from panic or fear, but sheer confusion at the dream she just had. Next to her, Adora continues to sleep soundly, unaware of what Catra just experienced in the dream realm. She flops back in bed and stares at the ceiling, perplexed and uncomfortable.

Why did she just dream that she was a trans man?

It's impossible for her to get back to sleep after that. Her mind spinning with all sorts of reasons and possibilities as to why she was dreaming this. It was so unexpected. She's a lesbian woman, that much she knows. Yeah, she's always been more masculine and likes guy things but not so much she would want to *be one.*

It unnerves her, these thoughts and hypotheticals. She needs to talk it out.

Her alarm goes off and it's time for work. She barely slept at all last night so today is going to be a rough one. Adora groans awake from the sound of her alarm and rolls over, grabbing at Catra like a child.

"Mmm don't go," she mumbles out. "Lay here for a second with me."

Catra giggles and relents. She's got a few minutes to kill before she really needs to get up. "Okay, baby. I'm right here," she says through a deep yawn and curls up into Adora's chest. Safe, she feels safe from her thoughts here.

"Sleep alright?" Adora asks, sleep heavy in her voice and Catra stiffens, which alerts Adora. "Nightmare again?" Catra's brain has always been a rough place to live in, especially with the history she had with harassment and assault. Adora is no stranger to nightmares either.

"Kind of?" Catra says after a couple moments. "I…I had this weird dream and I couldn't fall back asleep."

Adora strokes her short mane, kissing her forehead. "Wanna talk about it?"

Nearly a full minute ticks by while Catra argues with herself about whether to tell her lover. She knows Adora will accept her no matter what, but this… could change things. And it frightens her. Growing up she didn't get to really express this butch side of herself until she moved out of her parents house and lived with her grandma Razz through college. Then she blossomed and it all started making sense. But now, things are making less sense to her.

"…I had a dream I was a trans man." She keeps her face hidden against Adora.

Adora's petting never stops. "And how do you feel about that?" Her voice is even and steady, curiosity in her tone. Catra's heart rate picks up either way.

"I don't know," she says, her voice small and confused. It worries Adora.

"Hey. Catra, look at me," Adora prods and leans back to look Catra in the eyes. All Catra sees is love in those baby blues. "I love *you,* no matter what, okay? We will figure this out together. You aren't alone in this."

Catra blinks away the beginning of tears and nods with a small smile. "Thank you. I've kinda been mulling over this all night to the point I couldn't sleep," she admits with a nervous grin that Adora kisses.

"I'm sorry you didn't get a lot of sleep because of this. Can't say I wouldn't have done the same thing. You could've woken me," she says as she pulls Catra into a warm hug that Catra eagerly returns.

"Didn't want to wake you. And…I needed time to sort things out on my own at first."

Adora nods. "I understand. Try not to think about it too much today and just focus on having a good day in the studio, my love." She releases Catra with a deep kiss. "We can talk more tonight."

She feels much better after talking with Adora as she gets ready for the day and heads into the art studio in the city until she and Adora get a real home instead of an apartment and she can have a studio in her own house. But for now, what she has is fine, because it's a collaborated studio with other artists in it.

They are all queer artists who express their identities and sexualities through their art. Catra has become great friends with them all and feels safe here in this space. But the dream she has is something she wants to keep between her and Adora until she can manage her understanding of it better.

Catra’s got a big opportunity approaching. There’s the chance her work will be seen and displayed in one of the largest galleries in the state and many big name buyers will be there. So, she needs to make a great composition of works to sell and boost her name. She’s making *some* money now, but she would like more.

For a while she worked two jobs, selling her art and doing Door Dash. It sucked, to be frank, but money is money. And even though it took 6 years, Catra finally got recognized and appreciated for her art. Her wood engravings are her major attraction points because of its ties to her magicat culture, but now she wants to explore the world of paint.

Once at the studio, she sets her things down and gets to work, staring down her blank canvas and eventually grabbing a pencil to begin sketching her vision. Her mind is cloudy but she can’t let that deter her from getting shit done. This gallery opening is too important.

Knocking back more coffee, she picks up her paintbrush and begins.

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Catra left the studio early, too beat to push through 2 more hours of painting from her lack of sleep. She gets home and rolls onto the couch and is quick to pass out.

Their door opens and closes and it brings Catra back to the wakeful world. Catra looks over the back of the couch to see Adora walking in, and they share a smile together.

“Hey, how was today?” Catra asks first, not ready to talk about herself yet.

Adora shrugs. “Same old. Back is kind of sore though. There was a huge mural we had to hang and I was at a poor angle for most of it,” she explains and tries to stretch her back.

Catra stands and walks over to her, giving her a kiss as she cups her face. “I’ll knead you tonight. Sound good?”

A goofy smile spreads across the blonde's face. “Sounds perfect. Your hands are magic.”

Catra winks and heads to the fridge. “Sandwiches alright for dinner?”

“Cool with me!” Adora replies and they start building their dinners. “You’re home early. Something happen?”

“Just really exhausted. Used all my available brain power today from so little sleep.”

“Early bed time then,” Adora decides and the two sit down on the couch and flip on the tv. As they eat and watch a show, Adora continues to look over at her. Like she’s nervous to bring something up. Catra knows what, though, and decides to break the ice.

She swallows her food, drinks some water, and sets her plate on the table. Getting comfortable on the couch, she says, “I realized something while I was painting today. About, you know. The whole dream situation.”

“Mhm?” Adora inclines.

“It’s something I never told you before, because I thought it was normal for a dominant to feel this way. But…I think I get more out

of wearing a strap than it being just for sex."

Adora cocks her head, brows furrowed. "What do you mean?"

Catra exhales. She's going to have to spell it out. "Adora…" She swallows. "I think I *enjoy* wearing a strap *because* it's a penis. Not just because it makes us feel good when we have sex. But because it *always* makes me feel good. Does that make sense?" Her hands are trembling and her tail twitches nervously beside her. Adora sees it and puts her plate down too, turning to face Catra and give her her full attention.

"Okay," she says, nodding her head. "I can see that. I've never felt that way when I've worn it so it's hard for me to understand the feeling. But what you're saying is clear and I'm following you. Have you always felt this way?"

They keep their distance on the couch. Catra usually needs space when she is this open with herself and Adora has always been so kind about it.

"I remember when I first put it on. It felt so good, Adora. It felt *right.* Like I was meant to wear it. Remember how horny I was and how often I wanted to use it?"

Adora's cheek flush at the memory and she snorts. "Yeah, you were all over me," she smiles fondly and Catra blushes.

"Well—yeah. So, what I'm saying is, I think having that kind of genitalia, like, really turned me on. I thought it was nothing. But now I'm starting to think that it definitely means something." Catra pauses, debating on telling Adora this next part. Her lover waits patiently. "I—uh—I—," she stammers and has to look away. "I come better when I'm wearing it," she says quietly.

It takes a moment, but Catra finally meets Adora's eyes again and she blushes at how love stricken her lover looks. Adora licks her lips and says, "This probably isn't really helpful but that's really sexy, babe. Genuinely." Catra's eyes go wide. "I love when you wear it, and I love when you feel good. And if this is what makes you feel good, then I love it too. It's nothing to be ashamed about and I'm glad you told me." Adora pauses and her face goes red. "Can we try something? I think it might answer some questions for you."

"Like?"

Adora swallows. "You can say no. But…What if I sucked you off. Like…sucked off your *cock."* Catra's breathing goes erratic, now inexplicably turned on and wondering why the idea of Adora giving her head that way makes her so sweaty and wet. "Why don't we treat it like the real thing?"

Catra nods rapidly. "Yeah—Yeah let's give it a try."

The two scurry to their bedroom and Catra straps up. Catra stands, looking across at a red Adora who is making her way over to Catra with so much love and lust it makes her heart and pussy ache.

When she gets close enough, they kiss, and Adora asks, “Can I touch you?”

“Yes,” she replies breathlessly. Adora brings her hand around the dildo and begins to slowly stroke it, holding eye contact with Catra.

“You’re so hard,” Adora whispers and Catra whimpers as she continues stroking her. God, how she wishes she could feel it. Just looking is making her clit pulse with need. “Can I taste you?”

She can only nod, too overwhelmed. Adora leads them to the bed and Catra sits down, Adora between her legs, eyeing the dildo. Gently, she takes the length into her mouth and Catra gasps at the sight, her breathing uneven. She swirls her tongue around the tip then takes the length in her mouth, fully giving her a blow job like it's the real deal. Catra can hardly breathe and doesn’t dare look away as she gently guides Adora’s head up and down the dildo.

Holy shit , she thinks. This has got to be the best moment of her life. It terrifies her. Does this mean she wants a dick? Wants to be a man?

“Stop,” Catra says, cupping Adora’s face and pulling her off the strap.

Adora looks up at her with concern. “Is everything okay? Are you alright?”

She’s swift to get the harness off, pulling Adora off her knees and hugging her close as she leads them to bed, Adora nuzzling her soft chest.

“Sorry, didn’t want to talk until I had you,” Catra explains with her ears pinned back and Adora understands completely, kissing her neck and cheeks and her lips.

“We do this on your terms, love.”

“Thank you. I just… really, really liked it. And I just don’t know what it means. Like, am I wanting to be a man? Do I just want a dick? Ugh!”

Adora strokes her anxious tail, rubbing the fluff back down from her stress. “We got time to figure this out. And, just know, I love you no matter what, Catra. This is all pretty new and fresh for you.”

Catra shakes her head, sighing. “It’s not, though. I’ve had these feelings my whole life, but that dream brought it all to the surface.

I’ve always been jealous of boys, I tried to pee standing up as a kid. Sometimes I wish my breasts were flat. Not that I want them gone, but that I just wish they weren’t there sometimes. And I don’t want to get rid of my vagina or anything, but the idea of having a dick, as like, an option, I guess, is kind of appealing to me. Maybe it’s the more androgynous side of me coming out.

“Having a butch gender identity is hard because it’s so in between genders, and yet it’s own thing. You’re a woman, not a man, but you take on this form that defies both. It’s powerful and amazing and I know this is where I’m happiest. But why these feelings, why these revelations? I don’t want to go on Testosterone, I don’t want a beard and receding hairline or anything. I like where I am, but it’s not enough.”

Adora listens and holds her, taking in her words and thoughts, wanting to be as supportive and attentive as possible. “Catra, you’re amazing, you know that?” The words make Catra blush fiercely. “You’ve been through so much with trying to be your true self with your identity and sexuality. I think now that you and I are in safe spaces, we can finally explore these things, you know?”

Catra had to grow up with unloving parents who wanted nothing to do with her once she turned 18. Meanwhile Adora grew up with a gruff father that never raised her around the feminine side of society and it makes her feel disconnected from herself. Neither of them had great role models nor other queer people to confide in about these things until they went to college and met each other in their boring physics class. Catra didn’t know what it was like to breathe until the day she met Adora.

And she breathes easy now knowing she has her by her side through all of this.

"I love you so much, Adora."

"I love you so much too. Go easy on yourself with this, baby," Adora says softly. "Remember how long it took me to realize I was suppressing my femininity? I never thought I would break that shell I was trapped in. I'm still figuring it all out– trying to find what makes me comfortable, and I couldn't do this without you. So, I'm here for you, every step of the way."

Catra kisses her slowly, rubbing her thumbs over her cheek bones as she does. Pouring every drop of love she can into Adora. "You are the best girlfriend in the universe."

Adora blushes with a shy smile. She's still getting used to compliments. "Thank you. I just want the best for you."

"You are the best for me," Catra clarifies and kisses her lover again as she squeaks at the compliment. Adora melts. "My pretty girl," she coos and the blonde whimpers into her mouth.

Growing up with a hard ass masculine father who was terrified to see his late wife in their only child and daughter wasn't easy for Adora. She was forced to be a boy, because it's what he wanted. Not that she hated it, but she knew it didn't feel right. She's a girl, through and through. She would fantasize about wearing makeup

and dresses and having sleepovers, but her father never allowed it because he's a selfish bastard. He shoved his own wants down on Adora.

When she finally got out of high school and saved up enough money to get her own place, she moved out in a heartbeat and began saving up for community college. She still has loans to pay off but she will get there. She's always been able to manage large amounts of stress, even if she sometimes does a poor job.

But that's where Catra steps in. This guiding light that loves every part of her no matter what. When they met, Adora wore what she always owned, lots of flannel and baggy shirts and jeans. Catra helped her with her style and they went dress shopping for her which may have led to an emotional breakdown or two.

The thing is, Catra has been there for her since they met. And has become an even greater supporter since they started dating and living together.

So, yeah, Adora gets emotional when Catra calls her pretty things. She can't help it.

"And you're my handsome prince," Adora coos back and loves the flush that takes over Catra's features. "I just want you to be happy and yourself." They sit in the quiet for a while, running their hands over each other as they kiss when Adora gets an idea.

She pulls back from the kiss and asks, “Maybe you should talk to Bow. Being a trans man and all, he could have some good insight for you so you aren’t doing this blind.”

Catra’s ears perk up. She hadn’t thought of that, asking other people about their experiences. Her whole life she has had to do a lot of this discovery on her own while she researches online since she’s had to be so secretive about her identity. Butches are often times rejected from some queer spaces and its always pained her, but she knows someone like Bow could be a huge help for her journey here.

“Yeah, I’ll text him this weekend and try to meet up for coffee.”

Adora smiles and pecks her lips. “Ready for bed?”

Catra nods and the two prepare for bed and snuggle up, sleeping soundly.

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Catra is nervous. Her hands shake around the mug of coffee in Mara’s cafe as she waits for Bow to arrive. She tried to dress more masculine today in hopes of boosting her confidence, which worked a little, but only so much. The door rings open and Bow

strolls in and when he spots her waving him over, he smiles and heads over and sits down.

"Hey, Catra! Sorry for running a bit late, kept forgetting things as I tried to get out the door," he apologizes but Catra shakes her head.

"No need to be sorry, only got here a few minutes ago myself."

They both pull out their laptops, knowing their conversation will require some research and note taking. Mara heads over and asks Bow for his order.

"Hey you two!" Mara greets with a winning grin. "Any snacks or drinks– do you need a top off Catra?"

"Please!" Catra says and holds her cup out for Mara to fill up. "Bow, it's on me today."

Bow's eyes do that sparkle thing Catra has learned to love. "Are you sure?"

She nods with a soft smile. "I'm sure, you're doing me a huge favor today. So… my treat."

“Thank you! And, Mara, I will take a danish and latte please.”

Mara doesn’t even pull her pen and paper pad out. “You got it!” Then she struts off back to the bar and gets to work on his order with her wife, Hope.

“Well, let’s just dive right in, I guess,” Catra suggests nervously with a chuckle.

Bow gives her a warm smile, comforting her. “We can start with the first question that comes to mind.”

Catra nods once and takes in a breath. “I don’t know if I want to be a man or not. There are parts of being a man I do want, and parts I don’t want.”

He hums and says, “How about you write down what you want, like how you want to be perceived, and make another section for what you don’t want.”

“I can do that,” Catra says and begins typing bullet points on her laptop. Meanwhile, Bow is searching for something on his laptop. Mara brings him his drink and snack as he does and he thanks her.

“Done,” she says and turns her screen to show Bow her list. On the top it says:

WANTS

breasts???

uterus

short hair

mens clothes

penis???

And below that is says:

DONT WANT

beard

baldness

make up

breasts???????

to be seen as a girl, or to be seen as a boy. stop perceiving me all the time idfk

“Well?” Catra asks, exhaustion in her voice and Bow rubs his chin as he looks back to his laptop and scrolls through something.

“Have you considered being non-binary?”

Catra sighs. “Yeah, all the time. But it doesn’t feel right. I want a gender, not to be between or both. I want, like, *my own* gender that’s *me.”* She huffs and rubs her eyes. “I tried they/them pronouns but it never felt right. Neither does he/him. But she/her doesn’t hit the mark either.”

Bow types on his laptop everything she just said and nods along to what she’s saying. “I understand, not from experience, but what you are saying is so valid, Catra.”

“Thank you,” she says softly. “I’ve been like this my whole life, trying to figure out who I am, *what* I am. But nothing fits. The closest I’ve gotten to finding that puzzle piece was when I learned what being a butch lesbian meant.”

“Have you heard the term bi gender?” He asks and Catra shakes her head. “Well it’s when your gender identity goes back and forth between masculine and feminine, like some days you may feel more like a man, and others a woman.”

“See, that’s where I get stuck. I don’t want to be a man. I don’t mind being a woman. But like—,” she hunches down and whispers to Bow. “Why do I kind of want a penis? Doesn’t that make me a trans man? Or— or—like, I don’t know…” Catra groans and rests her head on the table.

Bow snickers at her and her head shoots up and she looks at him with confusion. “Sorry,” he apologizes. “I just remember going through this, trying to piece it all together. Not to say you are a trans man, but that gender and sexuality is really confusing to navigate.”

“Tell me about it,” she huffs and drinks some more coffee.

So, they go down the list of genders. Discussing them and testing them. It isn’t until Bow asks, “What about trans masculine?”

“Huh?” Catra says, scratching her neck. “How is that different from being a trans man?”

“So, there is the gender of transition and then there’s the expression itself. It basically means someone who identifies with a masculine identity more so than their assigned feminine identity.”

Catra rolls the word around on her tongue and looks it up on her computer to read more about it. She types it up in her notes as a possible choice. “You know…I kind of like that one. Because I’m still a woman, just not feminine. And i’m not a man, I’m just really close to it.”

“Yeah!” Bow agrees and Catra feels like she’s getting somewhere now. “Now, would that make you more comfortable using a

packer, per say?”

She’s heard this term before and has looked into it, but it scares her. “Maybe, I dunno.” Her ears go flat against her head.

“So, don’t bite me, but I brought some of my old packers and binders for you to try. Test them out and see how you feel!” He then whips out a grocery bag full of stuff in it. “There’s a foam packer, which just gives you a bulge, the real thing, and some jockstraps and a couple binder sizes too. I don’t use any of these anymore so feel free to keep and use them all you want.”

Catra takes the bag in a shaking hand. “Cool. Thanks.”

“Catra?” Bow gets her attention and she looks up from the bag to Bow’s warm eyes. “You do realize that a penis is not exclusively for men right? It’s not an inherently non-women thing. It’s just what society and culture have always treated it as because of heteronormativity taking over most of the world for so long. You can still be a woman if you have one, you know that, right?”

A million fireworks and bulbs burst to life behind Catra’s eyes, her heart rate picking up a bit at the realization. It’s like she’s been doused with ice cold water. She’s been thinking about genitalia all wrong thanks to the way she grew up. Her father, so toxic and ‘manly’ who forced Catra to be over the top feminine. And her mother, so submissive to her husband and clammed up at home and forced to play by his rules. It was all wrong and they put this poison in her brain about who she is supposed to be for *society.* Not herself.

“Thank you, Bow,” she says with a sniffle.

“Anytime, Catra. I’m happy to help,” he grins, bright and sincere.

The two hug and leave the coffee shop and head home. Catra walks in the door of her apartment, bag of items in her hand and Adora, who is on the couch playing a video game, asks, “Did you stop by the store too?”

“No, Bow gave me some things to try. To help me figure things out.”

“Cool! Are you excited?” she asks, getting up from the couch to see the bag’s contents. “You want to take a look?”

“Yeah, kind of nervous though. But, yeah, let’s check it all out.”

Together they open the bag and lay everything out. The first thing Catra does when she grabs one of the realistic packers is play with it. The girls giggle as it jiggles and bounces and stretches unrealistically. Eventually they settle down and have a seat.

“Okay,” Catra breathed and reached for the foam packer. “This is the foam packer. It’s just supposed to give you a bulge I think.”

She slips the foam pad into the jockstrap and begins removing her pants so she can slip it on.

The first thing she feels when she looks down at the bulge on her crotch is warm electricity. It bounces through her body like synapses as a calm washes over her in its wake.

"Woah." Catra finally looks up to gauge Adora's reaction since she hasn't said anything. "Well? What do you think?"

Adora snaps from her stupor, her eyes going from Catra's groin to her face. "Uh—what I think isn't as important as what *you* think right now, Catra."

"Hm," Catra hums and walks around the apartment a bit after she puts her pants back on. The bulge is still slightly there, but not obvious. It's different having something between her legs, but it's not uncomfortable. She does some stretches and it stays in place, not bothering her or getting in the way. She looks back at Adora who is smiling at her.

"You have a really big, happy grin on your face right now," Adora points out. Catra then realizes she is smiling, joy fluttering in her chest. She's happy.

She's euphoric.

“Babe, I can’t explain it. But this feels good!”

“Yes!” Adora cheers with a little clap. “Want to try something more real?”

Catra eyes the packers on the table and shakes her head. “I want to live with this for a while. See how it goes.”

“Good plan, take it slow.”

Once again Catra takes her pants off to get a more solid view of her new bulge. “I feel really hot right now,” she winks and Adora smiles, coaxing her closer with her finger.

“Well,” she begins seductively as one hand squeezes Catra’s ass and the other begins to grope Catra’s packer. “You’ll never be too hot for me to touch.”

Once again, Catra’s breathing gets shaky from endorphins as Adora feels her up, making her emotions run wild. Adora has always had a way of making Catra feel like the only person in the universe. Making her feel so loved and accepted. She thrusts into Adora’s gentle hand and she moans. She feels so good in this packer, even if she still doesn’t know what it means. Adora stands and kisses Catra properly, passionately. Catra then takes the reins, being so turned on and props Adora on the kitchen table to grind her crotch into Adora which elicits moans from the both of them. Their hands are on each other's asses as they pull the other ever

closer, so close that they can’t take it and have to continue this adventure to the bedroom.

It’s nights like this where Adora feels heaven sent just for Catra. Adora feels just the same towards Catra, like the planet formed her from the greatest of stars.

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Catra is excelling in the studio since wearing the foam packer. It’s been about a week and she feels so inspired to create art and pour herself into her work. Perfuma, a trans female artist, notices the change in her ‘energy’ and claps when she sees Catra has finished yet another canvas for a series she’s working on.

“Oh, Catra! This is beautiful!”

Catra blushes with a smile as she cleans her brushes. “Thanks. I just feel really good lately.”

“That’s wonderful to hear, I hope things continue to be good for you,” she says and they look at her canvas together.

Catra decides to tell her what’s going with herself. She trusts her and everyone here is queer anyway. “I’ve started wearing a

packer. Bow helped me piece together that I'm most likely trans masculine.”

Perfuma smiles kindly, her eyes crinkling. “Catra, that’s amazing news. Congratulations on your discovery! That explains your confidence today.”

“Yeah, it’s just a foam packer, but it’s done so much for me these past few days. And Adora has been so supportive about it all. It’s been terrifying to navigate but it’s easier knowing I have people like you guys in my life to accept me no matter what.”

Catra knows Perfuma’s backstory in terms of discovering her trans identity. She was all alone trying to piece it all together and hiding from everyone. That was until she broke those chains of fear and decided to be loud and proud about herself. Even her art changed from this gloomy era to something vibrant and lively and so full of wonder once she got started on hormones.

“I’m not trans, I’m not exactly cis either, but I don’t feel non binary. So I just go with trans masculine and butch for now. It just feels right.”

“I’m so happy for you, Catra,” she says and Catra hugs her.

“Thank you.”

Catra cleans up her work space and heads home. She stayed a bit late today to plot out some more art and sketched it all down before she lost the thoughts. Adora understands and respects her art process and knows that sometimes Catra stays in the studio overnight when she is really enamored with a piece, though it's rare and Catra will always tell her when it will happen. Catra tries to always come home though, it's hard getting a full night sleep without Adora. And Adora has a hard time sleeping without Catra.

When she gets home, dinner is made and Adora is wearing something new. She's in a blue sundress that hugs her waist perfectly. Catra's jaw hangs open a little since it's rare to see Adora be so open with her clothing. Her hair is down too, which is also rare, and her muscles are showing which she usually hides.

"Woah, Adora, baby, you look gorgeous," Catra says reverently. She sets her bag down and walks up to a blushing Adora whose hands are fidgeting with the skirt of her dress as she bites her lip. Catra cradles her warm face, searching for her eyes behind her blonde bangs, brushing them behind her red ears. When she gets Adora to look at her, Adora finally smiles, even if it's only a little one. "There's my pretty girl," Catra says as she kisses her cheek.

"Yeah–um– seeing you explore yourself inspired me to try and be more myself. Get out of that shell my dad made me. I saw this between jobs and bought it on my break. I almost didn't, but I wanted so badly to feel good." Her voice trembles a bit as she speaks, her tone quiet like she doesn't want someone to hear her. Catra's ears hear her just fine.

"Well, do you? Do you feel good?" Catra asks, roaming her eyes up and down Adora's body before settling back on her face.

Adora nods a couple times, her eyes looking a bit wet. “Yeah, I do,” she whispers through a sniffle. “Sorry, it’s making me emotional. I couldn’t stop twirling around earlier.”

Catra cups her cheeks again and kisses Adora so softly that Adora whimpers into her mouth. The magicat pulls back a couple inches and asks, “Dance with me? I want to spin you and make you feel like the princess you are.”

Adora giggles quietly. “Okay, let me get the music,” she says and turns on the stereo to play their romance playlist. When she turns around, Catra has her hand out with a smirk on her face, but it doesn’t have the teasing lilt it usually does, rather, it oozes satisfaction.

“May I have this dance, my lady?”

Adora snorts adorably and takes her hand. “Yes you may, dear prince.”

Catra snickers and pulls Adora close and they begin to sway, Catra leading them through a simple waltz around the apartment. Adora can’t stop smiling and steals a kiss when they come back together after parting for the next part of the dance. Then comes the twirl and Adora watches and feels her dress float around her, Catra marveling in her beauty. Catra pulls her back in and dips her gently, slowly. Adora’s thigh rests right where Catra’s packer is and the girls gasp at the feeling. Catra pulls her back up, Adora’s back

to her chest just as the song changes to something more sexually charged.

Adora grinds her ass back into Catra and Catra grinds back, making them both pant at the growing heat between them. Adora reaches a hand back to pull Catra's face close to hers and they share an open mouth kiss that leaves them breathless. They readjust so Adora is facing Catra again as she hooks her arms around Catra's shoulders and Catra's hands go to her waist, continuing to sway and grind together.

Leaning into Catra's ear, Adora whispers with hot breath, "You make me feel so beautiful." Then kisses the base of her ear, making Catra shiver.

Catra mimics her and licks her ear, making Adora moan softly, her eyes fluttering shut. "And you make me feel so handsome and desired."

"All I want is you."

"You have me, forever."

They hold each other close, kissing as their dinner gets cold. Their stomachs growl in unison and the two laugh, finally parting and taking their seats at the table after warming up their plates. Dinner is delicious, Adora can't cook from scratch but she is very good at following directions for more complex meals and has

found joy in cooking, even if she makes a mess in the process. Catra cooked a lot growing up because it was expected of her, so coming home to a meal is new and comforting. Teaching Adora to cook has been a regular thing for them since they moved in together and is a cherished time for them.

Dinner is put away and the two head to bed where they snuggle up. Adora is wrapped around a purring Catra while Catra coils her tail around her lover's thigh. Tomorrow is the weekend and the lovers get to sleep in.

Adora wakes first and cracks an eye open as the sun slips through the curtains. She's on her back with Catra's head nestled on her chest. Idly, she runs her fingers through the fur on Catra's bare back as she checks her phone for the time and sees her emails. It's just after 9am and decides to let Catra sleep as she slips out of the bed to get some more water. Catra grumbles but stays asleep as she sneaks away to the kitchen.

Adora gets some coffee going and grabs the paper outside their door. She sets up the kitchen for pancakes and eggs then pulls out some fresh fruit when her back pinches. She sucks in air at the pain.

"Adora? You okay?" A sleepy Catra calls from their bedroom. Her sensitive hearing always able to pick up when her lover isn't well.

"Mmm," Adora groans in pain. "It's my back. Pinched again."

“Come back to bed and I will rub you, then we can cook breakfast together,” Catra orders. Every Saturday morning they cook breakfast together but Adora was hoping to bring her breakfast in bed.

Adora sighs. “Okay, give me a sec,” she says as she carefully walks back to the bedroom to take off her shirt and lay down on the bed.

Catra straddles her hips and begins gently rubbing and massaging along her spine. “How's that feel?”

“Better, keep going, just a little to the left, please.”

She adjusts her massages and finds where Adora’s back is pinched and rubs a bit more firm, making Adora groan happily.

“I think I want to wear a real packer today,” Catra says as she kneads Adora’s back. “I think I’m ready.”

“Yeah? Let’s try it out then.”

A few more minutes of rubbing and Adora feels a lot better, but is warned to take it easy.

Catra then finds the bag Bow gave her and opens it up to pull out a jock strap and packer. “I was reading the other day about packers, like what to start with. Bow said this one,” she says and holds up a very flimsy packer, “is called Mr. Limpy and is the best starter one.” They both snicker at the name while Catra covers it in cornstarch so it isn't sticky.

“Can I see it?” Adora asks and Catra hands her the packer. She examines it and squishes it a bit. “It looks kind of real. A bit heavy.” She hands it back and Catra nods.

“Yeah, it’s a cheaper one that a lot of trans men start with so they can see if they like it or not.” She puts the packer in the underwear and puts it on. It fits well and gives her a more phallic bulge that makes her mouth go dry. Who knew exploring your gender identity could ramp up your libido so much? Catra jumps around and the packer shifts a bit but stays in place.

Catra looks up at Adora and sees she is eyeing Catra’s dick. “Like what you see?” she asks, smirking and thrusting her hips. Adora licks her lips and looks at Catra.

“Uh– yeah. It looks good on you!” Adora says, flustered and smelling of lust.

Putting her hand in the underwear, Catra pulls out the packer, just the length, leaving the balls in the pocket so it hangs out like a real penis would. It doesn’t match her skin tone but she doesn’t care. She can’t help herself, Catra begins to slowly stroke and pretend the dick is real. The packer slightly hits her clit and it

shoots lightning through her body as she continues to stroke. "Holy shit."

"Want to get off before breakfast?" Adora asks suddenly and Catra answers by laying back on the bed.

"Would you mind stroking me?" Catra asks, a bit nervous.

Adora smiles wide and lays next to Catra and takes her cock in her hand, rubbing it up and down and it sends Catra into a frenzy as she grabs for her vibrator in her night stand. She finds and turns it on, resting it on her clit just beneath the packer.

"Oh–oh *fuck,"* she moans loudly and rubs circles against her clit as she watches Adora jerk her off.

Adora is panting, so turned on by the sight. She nips at Catra's neck and kisses up to her ear. "You feel so good in my hand. You're so big," she whispers and Catra groans even louder, already approaching an orgasm.

Catra humps into Adora's hand and pulls Adora closer by the chin so she can kiss her, tongues wrestling. "It feels so fucking good, Adora. I'm already so close…" she whimpers and Adora strokes her faster. Seconds later Catra comes undone and has one of the hardest orgasms she's ever experienced. "Hah, wow."

“You are so fucking hot,” Adora says lowly, obviously turned on and Catra pounces on her, pinning her to the bed as Adora grabs her ass to pull their crotches together and grind. “Can we fuck with this packer?” she asks quickly and Catra shakes her head, growling.

“No, but they do make those too.” She chuckles when Adora whines. “You want the strap?”

“Later, I need you now,” she says out of breath and pulls off her shorts and underwear and Catra doesn’t hesitate to put her fingers in her slick heat and rub her clit. Adora wasn’t going to lose another second waiting for Catra to strap up. She needs her so badly right now. Seeing her touch herself and get so worked up was so hot and sexy that she couldn't take it.

Catra bites at her neck and purrs loudly as she speeds up her fingering, making Adora cry out. “Thank you for loving me,” she says as Adora comes undone, soaking Catra’s hand. “I love you so fucking much, princess.”

Adora cries out and then collapses into the bed. “I love you. Everything about you is perfect to me,” she says through her haze, smiling like a goof as she pulls Catra close to kiss her.

Eventually they get out of bed and make breakfast to start their day. Catra wears her packer all day and feels amazing and Adora can’t keep her hands off of her. Euphoria has never felt so good.

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The two are at the computer and they search for more packers. Catra would like some of her own and get some she can use with Adora in the bedroom as well. They pay the extra shipping fee so the packages get delivered sooner and Catra can’t wait.

Waiting for the packages is painful but exciting even if she is a bit nervous to be going this far with her gender.

It’s while she is painting in the studio that she gets the text that her package has been delivered. Catra’s whole body lights up and decides to work on her art a bit more until she reaches a good stopping point for the day. She is far too ready for her packers to not wear them at this instant. Cleaning up her brushes and palettes, she hops in her car and heads home. When she gets to her door she can see the packaging and snatches it up with a smile on her face and heads inside.

Catra opens the packaging and unveils her new packer. It doesn’t match her skin tone perfectly but it’s close enough. The packer is a little firmer than the ones Bow gave her and is more detailed. She doesn’t hesitate to undo her pants and swap out her current packer with the new one into its new harness where it can hang free and euphoria overtakes her body and prickles her skin. It feels divine and perfect on her groin. She loves seeing it hang between her legs.

Next she opens the other product and it’s a packer they can use for sex and Catra immediately sets to cleaning it and getting it strapped so it can be used when Adora gets home tonight in a couple hours. Catra wants to make this night special for her lover and goes about making a nice dinner and fun movie they can watch. She preps the couch so they can eat and watch.

Adora comes in right as she is finishing dinner. “I’m home!” she calls out and beams when she spots Catra getting food on their plates.

“Hey, hot stuff,” Catra says and wraps Adora in her arms with a sweet kiss to her lips. “How was your day?”

Adora hums happily from the kiss and smell of the food. “It was great, yours?”

Catra smirks. “Got a lot done on my current piece.” She isn't going to tell Adora about getting her packers yet. She wants to surprise her after dinner. Leading Adora to the couch, she says, “Relax and start the movie while I get our plates and drinks.”

“You’re the best,” she grins and flops on the couch, pressing play on the movie as Catra settles in next to her with their dinner.

The movie is mediocre but it’s enjoyable enough that it doesn't feel like a waste of money. Their plates are cleared of food and Catra leans back on the couch, spreading her legs as she wraps an arm around Adora’s shoulders and pulls her in close to kiss her. Adora moans into the kiss as she rubs her hand under Catra’s shirt to feel the fur on her stomach. Catra shivers at the feeling and pulls Adora in by the back of her neck for a more heated kiss.

Adora gasps when Catra bites her lip. “What’s gotten into you?” Adora asks with lust in her voice as she trails her hand further up to Catra’s breasts to find she isn't wearing a bra. It gives her easy access to her nipples and rubs her thumb over them gently, making Catra sigh into her mouth with pleasure.

“This happened,” Catra says with a smirk, guiding Adora’s hand down between her legs by her wrist. Adora has noticed how much more sexy and confident Catra has gotten since getting more comfortable with her masculine identity and it's such a huge turn on for her.

She lets Catra guide her hand down beneath her pants and Adora smirks into their next kiss when she feels Catra’s dick. Catra pulls her pant’s waistline down and Adora pulls the packer free and she squeals.

“Oh my gods, it came!” she says with so much joy and Catra beams with her fangs. “Oh, babe, you are so handsome,” Adora compliments as she strokes along her lover's shaft.

Catra thrusts her hips as Adora rubs her up and down and the two moan at the view. “Thought I would surprise you.” Making her way across Adora’s jaw with her tongue, Catra runs her hand through Adora’s hair until her ponytail comes free. “ *Everything* came in the mail.”

“ *Everything* ?” Adora repeats suggestively and Catra nods with a fire in her eyes. It makes Adora stroke her faster, causing Catra’s breathing to quicken. “Fuck,” Adora curses. “You’re perfect in my hand.”

Catra growls as he tail lashes against the couch. “I’m going to rail you through the mattress tonight, princess.”

“I need you,” she begs as she kisses Catra’s neck. Then she hops down the couch and gets between Catra’s legs and begins kissing along Catra’s cock. Catra doesn’t take her eyes off the beautiful sight as her eyes threaten to close from the pleasure.

She tosses her shirt off and begins to tweak her nipples as Adora works her. “Don’t suck this one off, it’s covered in cornstarch so it doesn't get sticky,” she warns her and Adora pouts.

“Can I suck off your other one?”

“Yes, it will be just like a dildo but more realistic,” Catra says and Adora gets a filthy grin that Catra mimics. “It’s ready when you are, baby.”

Adora gets to her feet and begins undressing. “I’m ready now, please fuck me,” she says with eagerness and Catra cackles at her haste.

“Go lay down and I’ll get strapped up.” Adora skips to their bedroom and Catra follows after her, undressing as she goes and heads to the bathroom, the movie long forgotten.

Catra puts on the harness with her new cock and she feels so fucking good she could cry. Finally, she will get to really fuck Adora how she wants. She heads to the bedroom and Adora is laying back on the pillows then sits on the edge with wide eyes as Catra approaches her.

“Oh wow,” Adora says, in awe of Catra’s hardened length. “Someone looks happy to see me.”

Rolling her eyes fondly, Catra says, “What can I say, you’re the most beautiful woman I’ve ever met.” Adora swoons at the compliment and takes Catra in her hands again and begins stroking her.

Rocking her hips forward, Catra groans when Adora puts her lips to the tip and swirls circles with her tongue. This doesn’t feel real and Catra’s body is lit up with fire. Adora bobs her head down further on her cock and Catra’s eyes roll back. She can’t feel a thing but it doesn’t make it any less amazing. Her hand winds

through Adora's hair and she guides her up and down her length, the two of them moaning happily.

Catra pulls Adora off and presses her back into the bed so her legs are dangling off the edge. She brings her fingers down to Adora's sex and slips them through her folds, making the blonde's back arch off the bed.

"Oh, Catra," she whimpers. Catra leans over her as she fingers her and kisses her deeply. Adora cards her hands through Catra's short mane as she preps her pussy.

"I got you," Catra whispers and guides her further onto the bed so she is more comfortable. Once Adora's head is on the pillows she bends her legs and spreads wide as Catra descends on top of her like a heavy blanket.

Adora can feel her cock rocking against her heat and she whimpers again, needing more and Catra can tell so she leans back and grips her dick. She lines herself up and presses the tip to her entrance.

"Ready? Stop me if it hurts," Catra tells her and Adora has a love drunk smile on her face.

"Plow me, oh sweet prince," she teases and Catra snickers. She presses the tip in and Adora's head falls back, her smirk vanishing into ecstasy as Catra enters her.

Catra takes it slow, working Adora up to each inch as she squirms and whines. “Fuck, you are so sexy,” she says reverently. “My pretty girl.” Leaning down to kiss her, she slips the rest of the way inside and Adora cries out as she fills her.

“Yours–oh-ohh– *please* , Catra,” she moans and holds Catra close, feeling her warm breasts against hers. Catra pulls back and thrusts back inside slowly and Adora sees stars. Then she picks up the pace and Adora has to dig her nails into Catra’s back just to stay attached to reality.

She’s panting as she fucks Adora, railing her faster and faster as Adora wraps her legs around her waist. “You’re taking me so well, so perfectly– fuck,” Catra gasps out as she humps into her. Adora lets out a string of whines that is music to Catra’s ears.

Catra leans back on her heels so she can fuck Adora deeper and sees Adora hanging onto the sheets for dear life and Catra goes deeper and harder. Watching her cock, Catra sees herself slip in and out of Adora's wet sex with ease and it makes her feel so alive and so in love.

“I love you so much, Adora.”

“Ah–ah–ahh–shit–I-I love you too,” Adora struggles to say as she reaches her peak. “I’m close,” she pants and brings her hand down to rub against her clit with rapid speed. Catra can feel her

walls tightening and changes her pace to quicker, shorter thrusts as she presses in deeper, holding her legs open.

"Cum for me," she commands as she continues to fuck Adora through her orgasm and Adora wails and her whole body shudders. Catra pulls out slowly once Adora has melted into the sheets and decides to keep rubbing herself off with Adora's slick.

Adora finally opens her eyes to the sound of Catra's pants and sits up. "Want me to eat you out while you stroke yourself, baby?"

Catra nods, trying to think through her haze. "Y-yeah." She lies back, her dick in the air as she fucks herself and Adora crawls between her legs. "Don't go inside, just my clit," she requests and Adora happily complies as she gets her mouth to work and Catra groans deep within her throat when her tongue makes contact with her throbbing clit. "Oh fuck, just like that baby girl."

Adora loves being her baby girl and works faster as Catra reaches her own peak. She suckles and flicks her tongue against her partner's clit and soon Catra is gushing into her mouth. But she doesn't pull away until she has licked Catra clean. "You taste so good, baby. You're so sexy."

Splayed out on the bed, Catra hums as she rests in the afterglow. Adora additionally licks Catra's cock clean and it gets them both riled up again.

Sex has never been so fun.

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“Adora? Are you alright in there?” Catra asks from the other side of the bedroom door. She could hear small cries and smell salt in the air when she came home, making her panic. She wants to give Adora the space she needs if that’s what she wants, but she needs to know if Adora needs physical contact right now as well. “I’m right here if you need me, okay? Or I can wait in the living room.”

Adora cries louder at that, feeling so cared for and understood by one of the only people who ever truly loved her. She does her best to get her breathing under control with some deep breaths so she can respond to Catra.

“Could you get me a water?” Adora asks and adds, “And bring it to me? I need you.” Catra practically runs to the kitchen to get her a drink then slowly opens their bedroom door to see Adora curled up on the bed surrounded by wadded tissues.

“Oh, sweetheart,” Catra says softly and Adora hiccups with a sob. The magicat helps Adora sit up and drink some water as she kisses her head and rubs her back. When Adora has drunk half the glass, she sets it on the table and Catra joins her on the bed. Catra leans back against the headboard and pulls Adora to her

chest where her lover can hide her face in her neck. “Let it out if you still need to. I’m not going anywhere.”

“I-I—“ Adora tries to say but she still has some tears and sobs to work through and Catra holds her tighter, peppering her head in kisses as she purrs. Adora melts into the hold and finally feels ready enough to actually speak now. “Ran into a bigot today.”

Catra hums and rubs her arm. “Take your time,” she says when Adora goes quiet for a while. Adora nods.

“He reminded me of my uncle.” The words make Catra’s tail slap the bed in anger. Adora’s uncle, her dad's brother, is a raging homophobe that was excellent at making Adora feel insecure. “He was an older guy and when he saw me working and lifting the heavier equipment for work he made a stupid comment about how I need to be a lady and let men handle these types of things. I…snapped and got right in his face and told him how wrong he was. How cruel his mindset is and he just laughed and mocked me.”

She does her best to remain calm, but Catra knows how much this hurts Adora. Seeing her in such a state is *rare* unless she’s been bottling up again and hit a breaking point. Catra thought she was doing well, having discovered and accepted more of herself.

“It just… really hurt to hear,” Adora murmurs. “Not because he was taunting me, but because he’s the kind of person to be so mean to someone like you, Catra.” The fight drains out of Catra, understanding why she is so upset now. Adora has always been

very protective. “He kept saying that women can’t do masculine things. It made me feel so gross about myself, because it’s everything opposite I was raised to think. I was raised to be a boy because being a girl wasn’t good enough. But I *am* good enough.” She looks up into Catra’s eyes. “ *We* can be whatever we want. We will *always* be good enough as we are. How can people live with so much hate inside them?” she asks rhetorically and snuggles up under Catra’s chin again.

“Thank you, for standing up for me, and yourself. It can be exhausting having to justify yourself all the time and make them realize you are valid,” Catra tells her and Adora nods into her neck, her hand busying itself with Catra’s chest fur. “Let’s not let this guy ruin our night, though, okay?”

Adora nods with an affirmative hum. “It just really got to me with all the progress we have been making. It’s been so hard, and it just hurts to hear. But I'm tired of crying now.”

Catra squeezes her tight to her chest then lets her go so they can stand up and Adora can freshen up in the bathroom while Catra looks through the pantry for dinner ideas. She sees they have enough stuff for a basic pasta and sets to boiling some water. Adora comes out of the bathroom, her eyes puffy and still sniffling, but smiling as she helps Catra make dinner.

“Thank you for taking care of me,” Adora says with a warm smile that Catra reflects as they prepare the food.

It’s taken a couple years, but Adora is finally letting herself *feel* her emotions so Catra knows this cry was long overdue. Adora always felt weak for crying but now she’s learned it’s okay. “Sometimes we just need a little bit to break and rebuild,” Catra tells her. “I’ll always be here for you.”

The couple leans in for a slow and passionate kiss.

“How was your day?” Adora asks her lover and Catra’s ears twitch down a little. She waits for Catra to respond, letting her think.

Catra busies herself with stirring the sauce as she mulls through her thoughts. She…had a lot of dysphoria today. “I think…I don’t know…Lately I've been feeling—just… ugh,” she sighs. “I don’t know how to put this but I want to try wearing a binder,” she says softly, keeping her eyes on the pot she’s still stirring.

“Okay,” Adora says with a nod and rubs Catra’s back. “You’re really brave, babe.”

Her cheeks flush at the words and her tail twitches from the warmth in her stomach. Catra hates admitting to things but with just Adora here, it’s easier. “I’m scared. Like, what if I hate it? What if I *love* it? Adora, surgery scares the shit out of me,” she explains.

“There’s only one way to know about all this,” Adora says gently. “You can keep living with those wild thoughts and questions about

what you don't know, or you can find some answers. I think you'll feel a lot better when you get your answer. Just like with the packers. I've never seen you so…comfortable with yourself."

Catra stops stirring the sauce and turns the burner off when the timer beeps. She turns to face Adora and takes her hands. "I didn't know what it was like to love myself for a very long time. Then you came into my life and I feel happy. I want to be happy because of you."

Adora scratches behind Catra's ear and the magicat melts into her palm and it makes the blonde smile. "Catra, I will love you no matter what."

"Thank you," she says quietly. Adora holds her close and then they begin setting the table and eating their dinner. As they eat, they research about binders and Catra starts to feel more confident. Once they have cleaned up the kitchen, Catra pulls out one of the binders Bow gave her, and though they are a bit bigger than she needs, they should still be effective.

Catra removes her shirt and bra and takes a deep breath and puts on the binder. It's *tight,* she notices. It's such a struggle to get on that Adora has to help her get it over her shoulders. Eventually it slides into place and Catra looks down at her chest. She already has a small chest, but without a bra you can tell she has tits. Now, she's completely flat and it's hard to take deep breaths but she pushes forward and puts her shirt back on to see the real results. She gets her shirt on and looks in the mirror and she nearly gasps. Her breasts are impossible to spot.

Next to her, Adora waits patiently as Catra moves her arms around with the binder. It's a bit uncomfy with her fur but it's not terrible. Catra doesn't feel euphoria like she did with her packer, instead she feels disappointed and confused.

"Help me get it off?" she asks Adora who sets to helping her take the garment off over her head. When it comes off, Catra instantly feels better and exhales with relief. "I'm not a huge fan of crushing my boobs."

"A no-go?" Adora asks her and Catra nods her head.

"I don't *love* my breasts because of how much they define me, but I don't hate them enough to want to crush my ribs." Catra's ears are downturned, a bit gloomy at not getting a solid answer about this.

"Maybe it'll make more sense down the line?" Adora tries and Catra walks to her for a soft embrace.

"Maybe," she murmurs. "It has to make sense someday."

Adora nods and kisses her ear, running her hands up and down her furry back. "It has to, I know it will. You'll find yourself."

Catra purrs softly, loving the comfort Adora is so good at providing. "I know how much you love my tits."

Adora huffs with a smitten smile. “It’s your body, babe. It doesn’t matter what I want. I just want you to be happy and feel good in your skin.”

“Yeah,” Catra says, “I’m getting there.”

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The art gallery opening is growing near and Catra has been spending more time in the studio to get her pieces done in time. Adora is often already in bed when Catra gets home, and she misses her a lot, but she knows how much this means to Catra. Although, every night when Catra climbs into bed Adora knows Catra misses her too with how close she holds her. Tonight, Catra comes home later than usual, Adora already asleep, but she wakes up when she feels Catra crawl into bed.

"Mm?" Adora hums, sleepy and barely awake.

"Shhh," Catra says as she kisses her cheek and pets her hair. "Just go back to sleep princess."

Adora rolls over and blindly looks for Catra in the night, wanting to hold her. Catra knows what she wants and curls up under her chin. Strong arms wrap around her as Adora holds her close and buries her nose in her mane. The two sigh contentedly.

"Missed you today," Adora mumbles and yawns as sleep threatens to take her.

Catra kisses her bare shoulder and rubs her side, Adora humming at the feeling. "I missed you too. A lot. I'm sorry."

"No apologies. Just really love you," she says, almost unable to get the words out as sleep overtakes her.

"Love you too, princess," Catra says with so much affection and Adora begins to breathe evenly. Catra stays up for a while, enjoying Adora's presence after missing her so much today.

It's two weeks until the gallery opening and it's time for Catra and Adora to select their outfits for the special night. The combination of wearing a packer in a suit has Catra feeling like she's on air. Her confidence is through the roof as she checks herself out in the mirror, a huge grin on her face.

Catra has on slim black slacks, and white button shirt tucked in with a brown belt and brown loafers. To top it off, she found a gold wrist watch to match Adora's gold earrings and necklace.

Beside her, Adora is getting into her dress. At first, Adora was so conflicted about wearing a dress or a suit. Part of her wanted to wear a suit because it's what she is most familiar with, but the other part of her wanted to feel pretty and elegant.

"Adora, it's your given right to feel pretty about yourself," Catra had told her in the car on the way to the shop. "This may be my

night, but it's yours too. I couldn't have done any of this without you. Pick out what feels right and makes you happy."

Adora swallowed down her emotions and nodded. "Okay. I really want to wear something white. Something flowy and sleeveless."

"Sounds beautiful. We'll find it and I will pick a suit to match."

When Adora gets her dress on she looks in the mirror and *beams.* "I wasn't sure about this one but…I love how it hugs my curves. What do you think?"

Next to her, Catra's mouth goes dry as she takes in girlfriend. "Yeah," she says dumbly and Adora snorts and sways her hips a bit and Catra nearly passes away. The dress is white and comes down to just above her knee, it isn't tight, but it isn't loose either. One of her shoulders is covered as the fabric slings across her chest and down the rest of her body.

"I'm going to try the other ones on to be sure. Don't pass out on me, Catra," she winks and Catra has to take several deep breaths to make good on that promise.

It doesn't take long for them to decide what they are going to wear, and then it's time for them to head to the tailors. They step into the shop and are greeted by Spinnerella and Netossa, a married lesbian couple that has been fighting for gay rights for decades and hold this tailoring business to protect queer folk.

Both of them know about Catra and her artworks as well as the fellow artists she works with, and they greet each other with hugs when Catra and Adora step in.

"Hey, you two!" Netossa says and pulls Catra in for a hug and Adora hugs Spinnerella.

"Hey, guys," Catra greets with a smile and goes to hug Spinny.

"It's been too long," Adora says as she hugs Netossa and Spinny nods.

"It's really great to see you both," she says as they get to changing into their clothes.

Catra goes first and dresses up. Netossa takes her measurements and Spinny writes them down for her. Catra has never had a suit tailored for herself before and it makes her heart swell with gratitude. Gratitude for Adora for being with her every step of the way and being a part of a loving community.

Then it's Adora's turn and she slips into her dress and her measurements are taken. She looks like a goddess on the platform and Catra can't help but stare and swoon for her. Adora notices and blushes but sends her a wink as she smirks, feeling confident in her body and figure as well.

Clothing and fashion is such a crucial thing for the queer community to express themselves so getting this done is monumental. Adora can't get over how drop dead *handsome* Catra is in her suit. She can't wait to see her when it's tailored.

The couple changes back into their regular clothes and leave their garments for the tailors.

"It'll be ready in a week," Netossa says as she takes the clothes to the back.

"We will call you when they're ready," Spinny tells them and she waves them off as the young couple heads out the door.

The two decide to get dinner while they are out and stop by a local restaurant that they dine at. Neither of them can take their eyes off each other. After dessert, they drive home and are both eager to make it to the bedroom.

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Tonight is the night. Catra checks her mane for the 7th time, making sure it stays in place where it is slicked back while Adora finishes up her makeup. It isn't often Adora wears makeup, but tonight was too special to go without it and does some simple blush on her cheeks with a light layer of lip gloss. Catra is in the

kitchen waiting on her and when she finishes and steps out of the bathroom Catra gasps.

Her mismatched eyes are wide, her pupils dilated as her tail sways slowly. Adora has seen this look so many times, but it has never felt as powerful as it does now.

“I’m going to ravish you in that dress tonight,” Catra states and Adora giggles, blushing furiously.

“I was really hoping you would, tiger,” she says, cocking an eyebrow. “You look so dashing that I want you to fuck me in that suit.”

Catra purrs loudly and the two close the distance with their lips. When they pull back, Catra says, “Let’s go, princess.”

Adora takes her hand and they head out to the car and make their way to the gallery. They're both nervous, but know they shouldn’t be, not when they are going to be surrounded by the people they love most. They arrive early with the other artists.

“Catra! Adora!” Scorpia hollers when she spots the couple walking across the parking lot.

“Oh. My. Gods.” Adora knows that voice, it’s Glimmer. She hasn’t seen Adora’s new dress yet. Adora wanted it to be a surprise.

Bow gasps next to his wife. “You guys are killing it with this look!”

Catra and Adora both flush but smile and appreciate the compliments. Perfuma gives them a knowing smile and says, “You guys are truly manifesting your love and identities through these looks tonight.”

“Thank you, guys,” Catra says as she takes in her friends. “It means a lot you all showed up for this.”

“Gotta admit,” Lonnie says, “You've worked your tail off for this, Cat.”

Catra feels odd hearing so much praise, but she’s getting used to it. She doesn’t want to deflect anymore. “I won’t lie, it’s been hard, but it’s been so worth it.”

Adora leans in and kisses her cheek sweetly and whispers, “I’m so proud of you.”

Looking at her girlfriend, Catra smiles softly. “You’ve been so supportive. Thank you… for believing in me.”

Everyone gets drinks and snacks from the buffet as civilians wander in to see the art. Famous artists even drop by, like

Mermista and Huntara— two well known queer artists in the country. Catra does her best not to panic when Mermista immediately makes her way over to Catra. Adora's hand comes to the small of her back and it helps her calm down. She kisses Catra's ear, completely smitten, and Catra can't help but kiss her on the cheek.

"You got this, handsome," Adora tells her and Catra takes a deep breath.

"Are you Catra?" Mermista asks, sounding beyond bored.

"Yes, and you are Mermista?"

She nods and holds out her hand to which Catra shakes.

"It's an honor seeing you here," Catra says and wraps her arm back around Adora's waist. "This is my other half, Adora," she introduces and Adora smiles wide and shakes Mermista's hand.

"Pleasure to meet you," Adora greets.

"Likewise, my other half is… *somewhere* ." Mermista searches the room and they spot him chatting up with Bow. "Good to see he is staying out of trouble. You can call him Seahawk. I promise he won't burn anything."

Catra snorts. She's very familiar with Seahawk's more *theatrical* and *involved* art demonstrations and performances. Which… typically include fire. It's more profound than one thinks of as destroying art. But he uses the ashes to make charcoal landscapes to push for awareness of forest fires.

"Can I get you anything to drink?" Catra asks her guest and Mermista smirks.

"This is *your* event. But…I won't say no to some champagne."

The two converse and Adora slips away to give them some privacy so they may focus on each other as they waltz through the gallery. Adora searches for Glimmer and spots her admiring one of Catra's smaller pieces, but one of her more precious works.

Glimmer idly swirls her wine as she inspects the piece. "Catra made this last year, right?" she asks when Adora comes up next to her. Adora blushes, knowing this work *intimately* . The subject is Adora nude in a field but it's impossible to tell it's her from Catra using impressionistic techniques.

"Yeah, when we went on a trip to Plumeria."

Next to her, Glimmer smirks, but doesn't say what she is thinking. Adora has an inkling, though and she blushes more.

“Are you Adora?” Adora turns her head to the sound of the voice and sees it is a woman, possibly an elf from the shape of her ears.

“Yes!” she says and shakes her hand.

“It’s a pleasure to meet you, my name is Francis. I’m Huntara’s girlfriend,” she says and juts a thumb over her shoulder towards Huntara who is examining one of Catra’s works. “I was hoping I could talk to you.” Adora’s heart beats rapidly. Huntara is someone Catra greatly admires.

Glimmer squeezes her shoulder and makes her exit. “Yes, of course,” Adora says, smiling. “What can I do for you?”

Francis smirks and steps a bit closer to Adora. “This may not be an appropriate atmosphere, but I was hoping to ask you some questions about dating a butch woman?”

Adora is slightly taken aback, her face puzzled. “Okay, what kind of questions?”

“So, I’m working on an article about the modern day butch and their art. Huntara has been looking for artists to work with.”

Slowly, the crease in Adora's brows lessens and her face becomes one of awe and *excitement.* "You…Huntara wants to collaborate with Catra, doesn't she?"

Francis smiles big and puts a finger to her lips, wanting this to stay a secret. "She will approach Catra later on, but yes, we want to combine forces with you two."

Adora gasps and does her best not to explode with joy. "This is amazing. How do I come into play?"

"You'll be an idol for feminine empowerment. Anyone who looks at you can tell you are jacked, Adora. Femininity is powerful, and we want you to spread that for us with your art installing skills."

Suddenly, Adora feels shy, but proud. "Oh, wow. This sounds amazing. I would love to help in any way I can."

Francis beams and says, "Yea, but we can go more into this later when it's more fleshed out. What I *really* want to know is about your butch."

Adora has heard of lesbians referring to their masculine partners as "their butch", but it still throws her off. "My butch?"

"Yes, how is it to tell the world you love masculinity in the most sapphic of ways?"

A soft smile crosses Adora's face as she thinks of how wonderful Catra is. How gentle her touches are, how she makes Adora feel safe and wanted in the most divine ways. "It's freeing, but it's also such a safe space for me. Growing up, masculinity was something scary. But when it comes from a woman, it's kinder, it's protective, it's grounding."

"I couldn't agree more," Francis replies. "Huntara has always been quite the protector for me."

Adora nods in agreement and begins to gush about Catra.

On the other side of the room, Catra is chatting with Scorpia about one of her old sculptures when Huntara approaches her. Scorpia makes her leave and Catra turns to face Huntara, her hand outstretched.

"Huntara, a pleasure to see you here."

Huntara nods and gives a pleasant smile as she shakes her hand. "Glad I could make it out. You have quite the eye for painting. It's been great seeing you branch out from your engravings."

"It was a learning curve, but very worthwhile once I found my stride. I wanted to get away from realism and felt a need to

explore shapes and objects in their purest forms. As well as work color into my projects.”

“Please believe me when I say that you are excelling,” Huntara compliments and Catra has to fight to keep her tail still at the praise. Her art is second to Adora on her list of precious things so to hear someone so grand think she is working wonders is knee buckling.

Catra maintains her mature and confident facade in this social circle, despite wanting to scream with joy. “It means a lot to hear that, thank you. Growing up I had little support for my art, but you were a huge inspiration for me. In my art, and my identity.”

Huntara smirks, looking only a little bashful, but Catra cannot read her well enough to tell. “It was hard getting to where I am now, as you probably know.” Catra nods. She is very familiar with Huntara’s childhood and younger years. Poor, homeless, abused and forced to become hardened in a cruel world that wouldn’t accept her. But she pushed through and is a beacon of hope for so many, like Catra. “You can become a great inspiration too, though.”

Her ears perk up slightly. “Been trying to get there, I’m glad you think so.”

“I have an idea for you in mind,” Huntara says with a huge grin and holds out her hand that isn't holding her drink. “How would you like to collaborate together on something monumental?”

Blood rushes through Catra’s body like white water rapids. For a few moments she just stares at Huntara before putting her hand out and accepting the orc’s hand with a firm shake. “I would love to,” she says and does her best to hide her breathlessness. “What did you have in mind?” she asks, eager to learn more about this proposal.

“Well, before we get to the art part, we need to get to know each other better. Walk with me,” she says and turns to lead Catra around the gallery as they look at her art and discuss their lives. Catra sees Adora talking to Huntara’s partner and blows her a kiss that Adora catches and winks, giggling, and the sight makes Catra’s heart flutter.

“So, tell me your pronouns,” Huntara says as they walk and meander through the growing crowd.

Pronouns, that’s something Catra hasn't given much thought before. “She/Her is fine, though it doesn't sit right. Like a puzzle piece that doesn't quite fit. But it's my default. You?”

Huntara gives her a soft look then turns to face ahead again. “I use she/her zi/zir.”

Zi? Zir? Catra has to ask her how to spell the pronouns and when she does, Catra feels like she has been hit by a truck. “What kind of pronouns are those?” she asks, her mouth dry, so she drinks more of her cup.

“They are neo pronouns. Something butch women used way before there was even they/them pronouns. There are a plethora of other forms to use as well. Those are just the ones that stuck with me the most.” Huntara dives into the history of the pronouns and different forms of spelling and Catra listens intently, absorbing this new information.

“I…had never heard of those before. Neo pronouns…” she says the new words quietly to herself, feeling them out. She likes them, she has decided. “I always felt so restricted by the basic 3 pronouns, he, she, and they. Hearing that you can just…defy spelling to your whim, so to speak, is really blowing my mind right now, if I’m honest,” Catra explains, feeling bubbly inside.

Huntara snorts a laugh. “That’s how I felt at first. I was sleeping in the attic of someone’s house just above their bar that they owned. It was a lesbian bar. I was still fighting the urge to suppress myself, but one night I went down and just started talking to them. I was tired of living in fear and anger for myself and the world. One of the most butch women I ever met immediately took me under hir wing and explained pronouns to me that night. That just because you're a woman, doesn't mean you have to use she/her pronouns. Pat was hir name. Ze told me hir pronouns and I felt a weight come off my shoulders. I felt freed,” Huntara tells her with a gentle grin. Then zi puts a hand on Catra’s shoulder and says, “butch isnt a dirty word, Catra. We are women, no matter what any asshole tells us. Our masculinity doesn’t make us men, or toxic. And that’s why I want to partner with you. I think we could make a great change in this world, even outside of the queer community. I have been wanting to work with you for a while, but I wanted to wait for the right time. And when I saw your mural, *Trapped,* I knew it was time to team up.”

Trapped was something Catra painted last year when she had a melt down at the grocery store when a clerk simply asked if she was a 'sir' or 'ma,am'. They were being kind, but Catra didn't know how to answer and from then she felt trapped in her body. That was until she discovered what it meant to be trans masculine, to be butch. To be herself.

Catra's mind is running a million miles a minute. " *Trapped* was a really hard time for me," she says and Huntara nods, listening as they walk towards the aforementioned painting. They both look up at the large canvas. It's dark, with jagged edges and paint strokes, but in the center there is a small glow of color, fighting to be set free amidst the crushing darkness. "It wasn't until a few weeks ago that I had a dream that I…" she swallows, "that I was a trans man and I began to question myself further."

For a few moments they look at the painting and Catra recalls the pain she felt and bled into this piece.

"I spoke with my friend who is a trans man and he helped me figure out I am trans masculine. I have started to wear a packer, the prosthetic genitals," she says carefully, gauging how Huntara will react to this new information. She doubts Huntara will judge her at all and Huntara's face only says 'go on, I'm listening', so she does. "I'm not a huge fan of binders, as I have recently come to learn, but that's me trying to learn that my breasts don't define me. But the packer, putting it on, made me feel more like a woman than I ever thought was possible. It makes no sense. And my friend told me our genitals don't decide gender and it all clicked for me. Things started to make more sense. I was raised to be submissive and feminine. But I have broken that way of thinking and I, like you had felt in that bar, began to feel freed."

Quiet lingers between them, both of the women pondering as they examine the art.

"I wear a packer too, you know," Huntara says with a smirk. "Changed my life."

Catra nods with exasperation, happy to be understood. "Right? I'm so glad I met another butch who gets it." The two laugh heartily and that's when Adora and Francis appear, each of them with a heated look in their eyes. Catra's ears twitch when she sees how red Adora's face is.

"Hey there, handsome," Adora says softly and kisses Catra with passion. She nearly squeaks at the sudden feeling of her lips but quickly melts and kisses back with fervor. When they pull apart, Catra can see Huntara is just as lip locked with her partner as Catra was a second ago.

"Hey, princess, did something happen that I need to know about?" Catra asks, voice low and husky that makes Adora's eyes further darken. The sight makes Catra possessive and she wraps an arm around Adora's waist and pulls her close to kiss her again.

Adora giggles into her lips and pulls back so she can look at her lover, a big smitten smile on her face. "Was busy telling Francis how amazing you are. How much I love you. Nothing *too* personal," she says with a wink and Catra's tail sways curiously.

Next to them, Francis laughs, her shoulders shaking. “We are just very fond of our butches, what can we say?” she says and looks fondly at Huntara who has a firm grip on her girlfriend as well.

“Uh-huh,” Catra says, deciding to talk to Adora about this later. Adora brings a hand up to card through Catra’s hairs on her neck.

“What have you two been up to?”

Then, Catra remembers she and Huntara are going to collaborate and she can no longer hide her beaming smile, showing all her fangs as she looks at Adora. “Baby, Huntara and I are going to work together and collaborate on some art. It’s going to be amazing.”

Adora squeals. Yeah, she already knew, but hearing Catra tell her about it makes it more amazing. “I’m so, so happy for you!” She kisses Catra’s cheek and hums happily. “You guys are going to be a powerful voice in the art world, I know it.”

“But that’s not all,” Francis says, giving Adora a smirk. “Tell her.”

Biting her bottom lip with excitement, Adora tells Catra, “They want me to help sponsor you guys and install your art!”

Catra can’t contain her happiness. “Really? Oh, this is going to be so fun.” She looks at Huntara who is wearing a dazzling smile. “Thank you both so much. It is an honor.”

“We won't let you down,” Adora says and the other couple shake their heads.

“No way you could,” Huntara says, “I just want to do the right thing, and I know you both will make it greater than I expect.”

The night goes on spectacularly, Adora and Catra feeling lighter than air as they enjoy the night full of art, opportunity, and friendship. As the night comes to a close, Catra and Adora say goodbye to their friends and head home. In the car, Catra has to ask Adora what she and Francis were talking about.

“Want to let me in on you and Francis’s discussion tonight?”

Adora sighs wistfully and looks at Catra with pure adoration. “We talked about our butches and how amazing they are. How much I love you and cherish you and am so thankful to have you. The things you have overcome and learned about yourself. What it’s like being with a butch and all that. She wants to have a more formal interview later when we get everything more set up.”

Catra feels emotion in her throat and through its thickness she says, “You sap.” Adora beams in the passenger seat and Catra falls more in love.

They make it home and when the door locks behind them, Adora is pressing Catra into the wall and takes a handful of Catra's bulge. It makes her gasp and moan as she holds Adora's face and slides her tongue through Adora's wanting mouth. Catra thrusts into her hand and Adora holds her tighter.

Catra growls and lifts Adora with her species' strength, the blonde wrapping her legs and arms around the magicat as they make their way to the bedroom. She lays Adora down on the bed and as she pulls away, she nips at Adora's bottom lip and the girl whines and groans. With heated eye contact, Catra removes her belt with one hand as the other unzips her pants. On the bed, Adora scoots further up on the bed and is quick to kick her shoes off and pulls her underwear down and off. Catra goes to the drawer and pulls out her performance/sex packer and replaces it with the one she is wearing, already having on the harness in preparation for this moment. Adora moans at the view of her lover's erection and spreads her legs as she pulls up her dress to reveal her dripping pink folds. Catra lubes up her cock and joins Adora on the bed and takes her place between Adora's legs.

She gathers her wetness with her fingers and Adora's head rolls back as she sighs happily.

"Catra…" she says and Catra loves her.

"You are so beautiful," she tells her softly and presses her fingers inside Adora who whines loudly. Catra leans forward to kiss her with as much passion as she can, Adora matching her energy as they breathe heavily through their noses, fighting for breath as

they keep their lips together. When Catra feels Adora's inner walls relax, Catra adjusts her hips and grabs her dick, lining up with the entrance to Adora's body. Adora whimpers against her mouth and pulls her impossibly closer when Catra nudges the tip inside. Catra is sucking a bruise into Adora's neck, wanting to not keep her mouth busy so she can hear Adora moan as she enters her. And Adora doesn't hold back as she gasps and jerks her restless hips as Catra slides inside, moans flying out of her body.

When locked in place, Catra sits up and looks down at Adora and tears prick her eyes. Adora's hair is messed about on the pillows and her chest is heaving as she grips Catra's hand for security as her mind slips away. Catra rocks her hips gently and Adora lets out a guttural groan, her eyes threatening to shut at the sensation but she keeps her eyes on Catra.

"I love you, Adora."

Adora smiles, all blissed out. "I love you too. Make love to me."

"Anything for my perfect, pretty girl," Catra says softly and Adora releases her other hand that was gripping the sheets and reaches for Catra.

The magicat leans down as she takes her hands, essentially covering Adora with her body and the blonde keens as Catra begins to thrust her hips in a steady pace that makes Adora come undone. As Adora gets closer to her orgasm she whimpers out, "Don't stop." Catra doesn't, not even when Adora reaches her peak, her second, her third. Only when Adora's whole body

convulses beneath her does she ram back into Adora's walls hard enough that Adora screams and her walls hold Catra inside so tightly does Catra stop thrusting and let her ride out of the orgasm.

Adora melts and breathes harshly for air as Catra slides out of her slowly. Catra kisses all across her face to bring her back to Etheria and grounds her as she cuddles her close.

"I got you, I love you," Catra whispers to her between kisses like a mantra. Eventually, Adora's eyes flutter open and there's a fire in them that Catra knows all too well. Adora rolls on top of Catra and kisses her and nips at her neck, making Catra gasp. Catra could come at any moment from just how Adora looks– all fucked out.

Adora palms her breasts through her shirt and kisses down her body until she is between Catra's legs and licks up the length of Catra's member. Catra groans loudly and even louder when Adora takes the whole thing in her mouth and sucks it clean. They get Catra's pants off and Adora settles between her legs.

"F-fuck," Catra stammers and Adora begins stroking her length as her mouth gets to work on her clit as her other hand holds onto Catra's tightly. " *Oh–oh–fuck!"* she moans and her hips thrust into Adora's tongue. Adora's strong arms hold her wild hips down as she sucks and flicks against Catra's clit and brings Catra over, the magicat whimpering out of her name as her body shakes with her orgasm. She came hard, and Adora knows she won't be able to get another out of Catra, not with her antidepressants messing with her ability to come.

Adora crawls up her body and kisses her up her stomach and chest until their lips meet. She holds Catra tight against her chest and whispers sweet nothings into the quiet space of their bedroom as they kiss. Catra purrs loudly into her mouth and holds her girl close. They lay there, half dressed and cuddled, kissing slowly as they both relax from their love making. Eventually, they roll out of bed and strip before getting in the shower and getting back into bed.

"You are so amazing, Catra," Adora says as they face each other in bed on their sides. Adora slowly kisses the calluses on Catra's hands from where she holds her paintbrushes and pencils. "So incredible."

Catra wraps her tail around Adora's waist and purrs softly as she holds her loving gaze. "I couldn't have done any of this without you. I know you'll say I did all the hard work myself, but I couldn't have found this side of myself without knowing what it was like to be truly loved by someone. I love you so much for just being in my life."

Adora rubs her thumb across Catra's cheek, feeling the soft fur there before pulling her in for a gentle kiss that feels like feathers. She brings Catra to her chest and strokes her mane as Catra wraps around her. "I love you too. I will always be by your side."

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It’s a couple months later when Francis and Adora sit down for their recorded interview. Adora wears one of her new favorite red dresses. A color as gently rosy as her cheeks that really makes Adora’s fair silky skin pop with grace. She feels relaxed and all around strong in this dress as she shows off her biceps and calf muscles with her low heels.

Getting out the door was hard with Catra being all over her and feeling her up. She blushes at the memory with a smile. Francis pours her a glass of water between them and sets the camera to record. They test their mics and make sure the lighting is perfect. Francis clears her throat.

“For this week's interview we have a very special guest with us today,” Francis says into the camera. “We don’t have an artist, but an art installer!” The camera pans out to show Adora smiling beside her. “Welcome to the studio, Adora.”

Adora beams, a bit nervous, but excited nonetheless. “Thank you so much. It’s an honor to be here, Francis.”

They share friendly smiles and begin the fun part.

“I know you are here for your other half, Catra, but this is about you, too. So, tell us a little about yourself, Adora.”

Adora wipes her hands down her dress, having gotten suddenly clammy. “To keep things short and sweet, I grew up here in this

city in one of the smaller suburbs. It was just me and my dad. He always saw women as inferior and raised me and treated me as a boy. Growing up I always felt wrong because of it. Then I got into art. Mind you, I am no artist," she chuckles. "But art helped me understand myself, especially queer art. It opened my eyes to who I could be. Even if that was hard to understand from years of repressed emotion and identity. I found my calling in galleries and installing art and since meeting Catra, I have been less afraid to be more feminine and show that a woman can have muscles and still be capable of anything."

"Always wonderful to hear people find themselves in this world. It's no easy task going through that self discovery. Sexuality and gender identity are so complex. Tell us about those hardships," Francis asks and Adora takes a deep breath.

"I never felt good enough as the real me. I was always told to 'man up' and 'not be a girl' about things. Growing up I had a lot of identity crises and struggled with self love. There was no one to support me, not until I got to college. Getting out of my dad's house helped me bloom and I made friends quickly and they helped me put myself together."

Adora blushes and smiles to herself at what she says next. "It wasn't until I met Catra that I could see myself as lovable. She knew exactly how to break down my walls and unlock the chains that suppressed the true woman inside me. We boxed up my old clothes and got a whole new wardrobe for me that made me so much more myself. It took years, but we got there and I'm so thankful."

Francis speaks with so much admiration when she says, “That’s truly amazing Adora. The paths queer women must take are difficult and scary, but you came out on the other side as a force to be reckoned with. You’re truly an inspiration!”

Her eyes burn and Adora has to dab them with a napkin so her makeup doesn’t smear. “Thank you,” she says softly.

“You’re so welcome! Tell me, Adora, who inspires you?”

“I know it’s cliche, but my lover, Catra, inspires me everyday. Yes I have idols and hollywood figures who I dreamed of being, but everything clicked when I met Catra. It was the first day of our basic physics class. I was always early to class but Catra always ran late. And that day she came in 10 minutes late and strolled in like she owned the place. At first I couldn’t tell if she was a man or a woman from how masculine she dressed but I was so enamored that it didn’t matter. She took the open seat next to me and she caught me staring. Every pore of her exuded confidence. Catra was never afraid to be herself and I wanted to be that way too,” Adora says and sighs wistfully.

She continues after a breath and says, “I remember her asking ‘like what you see?’ and I could feel my face flare up bright red. I’ve always liked challenges, and Catra had that shine in her eye that said ‘come on, don’t be easy’. It made me feel confident enough to say ‘Yes’. From that day on my confidence only grew and she had everything to do with that. Both with my sexuality and my gender identity.”

Francis takes a sip of water and shuffles her cards. “Such a beautiful story the two of you have,” she says sincerely. “You had to fight to be yourself, but once you met Catra it came naturally.” Adora nods with a smile. “But once you started dating a butch lesbian, you were back to fighting for your validation. I imagine that has been difficult for you both.”

“Yeah,” Adora says softly but takes a deep breath and holds her head high with confidence. “Yeah it’s been hard, but love always wins in the end. We get stares and we will hear people murmuring about whether Catra is a man or a woman. We have been harassed by cis straight folk as well as other lesbians.” She begins to fiddle with her hands in order to keep a lid on her anger. “Catra is as much a woman as the next one. Dressing masculine and looking like a guy doesn’t mean she rejects being a woman. She just isn’t feminine. Many accuse her of being a man when that’s the last thing she wants to be. Being butch is, in a way, it’s own gender identity. You’re a woman with the aura of a man. You’re in between and not accepted in any circles. It’s been hard but times are changing and people are becoming more accepting.”

“And it’s a massive relief people are raised to be more open minded!” Francis says with exasperation. “We are seeing our community in tv and in the media and it’s amazing to feel seen.”

Adora nods vehemently. “It’s been amazing, even if they get the representation wrong. Butches are basically portrayed as young immature boys instead of as women. And lesbians are still widely sexualized. But we will take what we can get!”

Francis sighs and shakes her head. “What doesn’t kill you only makes you stronger, am I right?”

“Completely,” Adora agrees and takes a sip of water. “We exist, and that’s that. Once people stop attaching masculine and feminine ideas to specific genders and sexes, they will see that butches are just as woman as a straight cis woman. Butches have a masculinity that provides protectiveness and charm that the other toxic side of masculinity doesn’t have. That side invokes fear and anger. It reminds me of my father. But Catra, she makes me feel safe and desired and secure with her and myself. Masculinity isn’t exclusively for cis men.”

“I couldn’t agree more,” Francis says. “Huntara has such a way of making me feel so safe and protected. Her masculinity has always been positive and kind. Alright Adora,” she says and puts her cards down and looks at Adora. “I have one more question for you.”

“Yes, of course!” Adora says, and feels eager for this interview to be over so she can go be with Catra. This interview has made her miss her lover dearly.

Francis gives her a sincere look and asks, “What would you tell your younger self?”

Adora gets a distant look in her eyes when says, “I would tell her that she’s worthy of love, and always will be.”

“That’s a beautiful thing to say, and something we should all remember,” Francis says. “Thank you so much for joining us today,

Adora.”

“It was my pleasure. Thank you for giving me and other queer people a platform to speak.”

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Catra took the day off from the studio today to catch up on house chores. She’s been struggling with a creative block on how to end her most recent art work with Huntara. The apartment is cleaned spotless, the dishes are put away, and their laundry is folded and done. Now, she sits on the couch and watches random crap on tv in case something inspires her. In her lap she has her sketch pad ready as she idly doodles.

About 15 minutes ago Adora texted her that she was done with her interview and heading home. Catra eagerly awaits her presence. Adora was always a strong muse for her.

Footsteps, very well known footsteps make their way up the cement stairs to their door. Catra’s tail thuds against the couch in excitement. The door unlocks and Adora enters and Catra purrs at the sight of her girlfriend in that dress.

Adora sees Catra’s pupils dilate and knows what she's thinking. “Hey tiger, I know you want to ravish me—“

“Uh-huh,” Catra purrs, her tail swaying as she stands and approaches Adora. Adora snickers and bites her lip, pressing her hand into Catra’s chest to keep her from leading the intimacy.

“—but I really want to take care of you tonight,” she says with a long kiss to Catra’s lips. “Please?”

Catra teases her with a hum, faux thinking as she gropes Adora’s ass through her dress. She kisses her and says, “Okay, princess. I’m all yours.” She’s always craved Adora’s touch, it’s always been so firm and gentle but harsh when Catra’s most desires it.

Adora chuckles and cups Catra’s dick, making her butch gasp and shiver. Catra begins to grind into Adora’s hand and already feels herself melting.

“Go lay down for me. Don’t strip, I want to do all the work for you.”

Catra kisses her with heat and reluctantly lets her go and heads to their bedroom. Adora watches Catra vanish through the doorway and she takes a moment to take her heels off, make a couple waters, and heads into the room. Her lover is laid back with her legs spread, bulge prominent, with her hands behind her head, smirking. Adora swoons but keeps her composure. She sets down the waters and changes their lightbulb’s settings to a romantic red lighting.

A tail thwaps against the bed and Adora smiles down at Catra. "I'm going to worship you tonight," she says and the words make Catra's ears perk up.

Catra looks ready to say something smart but Adora shushes her with her lips.

"Just relax for me," she requests softly and Catra nods, getting more comfortable on the bed. Adora stands back and slowly unzips her dress and sways her hips as she removes it and lets it fall to her feet. Catra's eyes widen at the view. Her girlfriend in all her naked glory with a full face of makeup. Stunning.

Adora slowly crawls up the bed and over Catra, and brings their lips together. They both moan into the kiss and their hands can't help but roam one another. As they kiss, Adora unbuttons Catra's shirt at an agonizing pace. But Catra reminds herself to relax and drift. Catra sits up to help Adora completely remove her shirt and bra before laying back down.

With the most tender of kisses, Adora softly loves on Catra's breasts. Her touch is like feathers as she teases her nipples and runs her tongue around them. Catra softly gasps with each flick and lick, becoming putty in Adora's hands. She runs her hands through those blonde locks and holds her close to her chest. Adora kisses back up her chest to neck and sucks there as her fingers gently twist her nipples.

“You’re so strong, Catra,” Adora whispers. “You inspire me everyday.”

Catra whimpers, overcome with emotion and stimulation. Adora begins to grind her pelvis into Catra’s packer and both moan at the sensation. Adora sits up and holds Catra’s hands as she continues to grind and hump.

“Catra, you make me feel so good.”

Adora stops her movements to remove Catra’s pants. She helps Adora remove them until all that’s left is Catra’s packing underwear.

“Mind if I swap you out for your hard one?” she asks and Catra nods. Adora opens the drawer and pulls out the harness with Catra’s erected play packer. She gets Catra all set up and asks, “Can I finger you?”

“Yes, please do,” Catra replies with a thick swallow. Adora lays down between her lover's legs and pressed her fingers inside of Catra’s velvet warmth as she takes her tip into her mouth.

Catra’s head rolls back but she’s quick to look back down at Adora working her.

“F-fuck,” she moans as she watches Adora suck her off just as she hits Catra’s g-spot. “Just like that.”

Adora picks up her pace but not so fast Catra can’t think straight. She adds another finger and sucks further down Catra’s cock, making her girlfriend groan and bucks her hips. When Catra begins to pant and whine, Adora slows down and pulls her fingers out and settles her opening right above Catra’s erection.

“I want to ride you, is that okay?” Adora asks and Catra smiles.

“I would love that,” she says with a husk to her voice.

Adora smirks and settles herself down and guides the cock inside her. Every stretching inch makes her gasp and whine. It’s music to Catra’s ears. Soon she is hilted with Catra and she rests her hands behind her so she is leaning back, giving Catra a full view of her taut abs as she begins to ride her dick.

Catra’s tail begins to thrash. Adora throws her head back and moans with each thrust. She wanted to put on a show for Catra but she doesn’t need to fake it, not when Catra fits so well in her pussy.

“Fuck you are so big, babe,” Adora moans and gasps. She changes positions and leans forward to hover over Catra and cups her lover’s face to kiss her deeply. Catra purrs into her mouth as their tongues dance together.

" *Adora,"* Catra whimpers, inexplicably turned on.

"You fit so well inside me," Adora tells her as she kisses her neck and rocks her body. She's beginning to lose her mind and feels her orgasm approaching. "F-fuck." Leaning back again, Adora brings her fingers to her clit and begins to rub it with speed. "I'm going to cum all over your cock."

Catra feels herself pool with slick at the view and Adora's lust filled words. She attempts to swallow but her mouth is dry with hunger. Adora's body shakes with her orgasm as she whines high and so full of love before crashing back down and melting into Catra's arms. But Adora isn't done yet. Her plan to take care of Catra involves getting her partner off, too. She pulls herself off Catra and nips at her neck as she palms her perky breasts. Catra is on a hair trigger to an orgasm and Adora knows it won't take much to get her off so takes her time sliding down her toned body, lathering it in kisses.

Letting her partner take the lead, Catra doesn't beg or plead, she knows she will be taken care of properly. So she lays back and shivers with each kiss to her thighs and furry mound. Adora strokes her cock and sets to work on sucking on her clit as she presses her fingers back inside her dripping folds. Catra moans loudly and bucks her hips and Adora lets her, not bothering to hold her still this time around. All she wants is what Catra wants.

Soon she reaches her peak and all tension leaves her body as a purr erupts from her chest and Adora lays on top of her with

comforting weight. Catra wraps her arms around her and kisses her languidly.

“Gods, I love you,” Catra murmurs against Adora’s cheek. “How did I get this lucky?”

Adora brings her face to Catra's and looks deep into those beautiful dual colored eyes. Eyes that she gets lost in everyday since she met her. Catra’s purr grows louder as she rubs behind her ears.

“I ask myself that question everyday. You are perfect.”

“Back at you, princess,” Catra says with a smile that shows her fangs, her eyes half lidded and drunk with love. Adora is sure her face reflects the expression.

“Shower with me?” Adora asks as she stands, pulling Catra with her.

“Absolutely.”

Chapter End Notes

i really loved writing huntara in this role

next up is the epilogue aaaaaahh

i got my degree in fine arts and art is a huge part of my life. i have dreams of having my own studio and getting in galleries like this. maybe one day. still got a lot to figure out about myself. living vicariously through catradora as usual. ive been in small galleries but nothing huge and i have sold art before. used to also work in a gallery and hang art for a couple years like adora here but covid killed that job sadly. who knows, might get back into in the future

epilogue

Chapter Notes

soft

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The champagne bubbles like the laughter in the room as Catra takes in the gallery showcase. Everyone showed up tonight and Catra couldn't be happier about it. She's got Adora hanging on her arm, her art partner, Hunatara, beside her with zir lover and it feels like a dream. Each person in the room waits for their chance to come and speak with the two artists and their partners about their work before the grand finale of the night.

In the gallery are art projects that Huntara and Catra made together over the last year which range from mediums of clay and plaster to paint and ink and even photography. The showing is magnificent and journalists are documenting what they see for their blogs and news pages for the world to see. Some of the work is sexually charged but neither of the artists shy at what is displayed. Every piece is a message and story and emotion of what it means to be a butch lesbian in modern day Etheria.

Catra was never good at being vulnerable until she met Adora and went to therapy. Her art, for years, was brash and hard, but has evolved into softer subjects and themes that explode with feelings Catra has struggled to make sense of since she was a kid experiencing her first kiss with a girl.

It's freeing being able to show every side of herself here tonight. She has thanked Huntara countless times for working with her

and being such a great inspiration and supporter for all of these new and past projects.

She hears Adora laugh beside her, pulling Catra from her thoughts. Their eyes meet and Adora's smile grows bigger. Catra wraps her arm around Adora tighter and kisses her cheek long and soft. Adora hums at the feeling and would totally kiss Catra back if it weren't for her lipstick so she settles for resting her forehead against Catra's.

"Catra?" one of the gallery owners asks as they come up beside Catra. "Are you and Huntara ready? We are all set."

She looks at Huntara who smiles and nods with a sip of zir champagne. Catra looks back at the owner and nods the go ahead.

"Excellent, follow me."

Catra and Huntara release their partners and head to the small podium. In her chest, Catra's heart begins to race as she and Huntara take their place behind the podium. Sheets cover every inch of wall in this room, waiting to reveal what lies behind it and Catra takes a deep breath, preparing herself. A hand comes to her shoulder and Catra sees it is Huntara, grinning.

"This is going to be amazing," zi says and Catra's nerves settle a bit more knowing her idol, turned friend, is proud of her.

She faces the growing crowd that funnels into the large room and sees Adora and Francis on the sidelines of the little stage, smiling and waving their support. Adora blows her a kiss and Catra snorts and definitely hears her friends cooing.

Once the room settles and everyone is in, Catra clears her throat.

"Thank you all for making it out tonight. I see a lot of familiar faces, but many new ones as well," she says to the crowd through the small mic before her. Cameras flash and it bothers her sensitive eyes but she ignores it, pressing on. "Tonight is very special, as well as crucial, for the queer community. Specifically for the butch lesbian community. Someone I admired for years is here next to me, and zi has now become a close friend and confidant."

Catra turns to face Huntara and her partner steps forward. "Huntara, as many of you well know, has made an everlasting impact in the butch world through art. Huntara came to me last year and asked to work with me on a collaboration of art projects to spread awareness of butch lesbians everywhere. If it wasn't for zir, I don't think I would be standing here today."

Taking a step back from the mic, Catra lets Huntara step forward to say a few things.

Huntara then addresses the crowd. "It has been an honor to work with Catra and I am more than proud of the art we have created

to project our voices. Growing up in a hateful world that lacks understanding is difficult, but it makes us strong forces of nature and is what makes the queer community so powerful. But I found that through art, our voices are projected louder than in many other ways. Art helps us get a message across without the need for painful arguments."

Zi steps to the side and Catra joins Huntara at the podium and she says, "So it is with great pleasure, that we show you all what we have been dying to share with you."

Huntara gives the hand signal and all the thick sheets begin to rise into the ceiling. The audience gasps and claps as the walls are revealed to show beautiful, ornate, stained glass windows on the right and left hand side of the room. On the front and back walls are endless painted words of affirmations.

"The stained glass was designed by the both of us," Huntara says. "And it was manufactured in a glass studio owned by queer couples. It was a learning curve, but together, we created something that represents the history of being butch."

Each window has a crucial and significant moment displayed all the way back to hundreds years of the first documentations of the word butch used in queer terms. The final stained glass window shows a present day butch woman, Juliette, that fought for equal representation and an end to butch violence last year.

Catra then explains the writings. "The other walls are all hand painted by fellow butch lesbians that we either met on the street,

at clubs, or came to our studio to participate in its creation. Everyone wrote what it meant to be who they are. But this room is so much more than just a pretty place to look at. This room will also become a center for butch lesbians wanting to showcase their art."

"Being an artist and making art is easy," Huntara says. "But making it a profession and having your work seen and heard is hard. So, we decided to make this a space where every month, artists can be seen and make a name for themselves. The money made will be donated to the Home for Love foundation which homes homeless lgbtqia kids."

The crowd erupts in a loud applause and Catra steps up to say some final words when everyone settles down.

"Butch is *not* a dirty word. We are people of love and protection and are just as lesbian as the next one. Huntara and I decided to title this artful room as *Love Incarnate* to represent what we have fought for for over a century. We couldn't have done it without our beloved partners," Catra says with a large smile and waves for Adora and Francis to come beside them. The two women approach their lovers and wrap them in tight hugs, kissing them sweetly and leaving lipstick on their faces which makes the audience laugh and clap again.

"I'm so proud of who you are," Adora whispers to Catra as they take in the crowd and art.

Catra smiles softly and holds her close with her arm then addresses the crowd one final time.

"Love is never something to give up on. Each and everyone of you can make a difference. It's when we come together that we are stronger, don't forget that."

The couples step down from the podium and into the crowd to shake people's hands and answer journalist questions as light shines through the colorful stained glass. Catra never lets go of Adora's hand for the rest of the night.

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It's three years later down the line when Catra wakes up to a naked Adora in xir arms. Feeling her skin against Catra's bare fur was always a calming sensation. Catra remembers when xi used to wake up feeling dysphoric and depressed and thinking xi had to be a man to be happy. But that was so far from the truth. Xi's a woman, through and through, just a very masculine one and that doesn't invalidate who xi is in the slightest.

Catra brings her left hand up and sees her wedding band shimmer in the morning light and then looks down to her stomach where Adora's left hand rests and wears her wedding ring too. They are laying in their king size bed of their new home that they could finally afford last year.

She got the girl, she got the job, and she got the home.

Now all that's left to do is live the life she has come to realize that she deserves. And live it fully she has over the last 3 years.

Adora mumbles, "Mmmm….Mornin'."

Catra rubs her side and uses her other hand to bring her chin up for a kiss on the lips. "Morning princess."

Adora runs her fingers through Catra's stomach fur, making the magicat purr happily. "Your thinking woke me up," the blonde says softly, her eyes closed as she comes out of sleep slowly.

"Just happy, is all," Catra says and kisses Adora's head who sighs contentedly. They spent most of the night love making and are thoroughly exhausted and drunk with affection even hours later.

"That's not a word you use often about yourself. I'm so glad you feel happy, baby."

Catra hums. "I guess you're right. I just kind of realized that I got everything I wanted, even if the world is still cruel. I got you and that's what matters. It gives me a painting idea, actually."

Adora sits up, leaning over Catra on her forearms, her breasts pressed against Catra's. "You going to go into the studio today?"

"Yeah, later though. I want to spend more time with you in bed."

Adora beams and bites her lip then leans down to kiss Catra long and hard on the lips then trails down xir cheek and neck, all the way to xir collar bone. "I like that idea."

"More," Catra requests and Adora giggles like her throat is made of honey.

"Anything for you, handsome."

Yeah, Catra still has some things to figure out. But when this is xir life, these delicate mornings, xi knows xi will be just fine.

Chapter End Notes

thank you so much for reading everyone. this fic means the world to me. all of your comments have been so touching and inspiring

i hope to come back to this one day and add more as my journey as a butch woman ever evolves!

im currently working on original works of 2 lesbian ocs i have had for many years now and i think you guys will love them. Chiyo and Zereph. very soft and tender women. keep an eye

out for those in the coming weeks if you are interested! there will be their origin story, a smutty and fluffy one shot, and a cute one shot in the works

End Notes

been dying share this with yall for over a year now. i wrote this while i was discovering myself and my butchness and i couldnt have done it without my friends and girlfriend. yes i am butch. yes i am trans masc and am still a woman. yes i am a lesbian. yes we exist.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!